National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Key Largo, FL	**Accident Number:**	NYC08CA063
Date & Time:	12/13/2007, 1800 EST	**Registration:**	N961PH
Aircraft:	Maule M-7-235	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	4 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot of a float-equipped Maule M-7-235 noted a rain squall in the "immediate area" of his planned water landing. The pilot decided to land 1/2 mile to the northeast, into a northeast wind. Upon touchdown, a wind gust lifted the right wing with more force than the pilot could counteract. The airplane's left float submerged, then separated, along with the strut, from the wing. The airplane spun to the left, and the right wingtip struck the water. The pilot reported about 350 hours of flight time, with 100 hours in model, and 75 to 100 water landings within the previous year.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The pilot's loss of control during the landing. Contributing was the wind gust.

Findings

Occurrence #1: DRAGGED WING,ROTOR,POD,FLOAT OR TAIL/SKID
Phase of Operation: LANDING

Findings
1. TERRAIN CONDITION - WATER
2. (C) AIRCRAFT CONTROL - NOT MAINTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND
3. (F) WEATHER CONDITION - GUSTS

Factual Information

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private	**Age:**	56, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Multi-engine Land; Single-engine Land	**Seat Occupied:**	
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 3	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	09/01/2006
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	350 hours (Total, all aircraft), 100 hours (Total, this make and model)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Maule	**Registration:**	N961PH
Model/Series:	M-7-235	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	4086C
Landing Gear Type:	Float	**Seats:**	
Date/Type of Last Inspection:		**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	486 Hours	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-540
Registered Owner:	George Wilson	**Rated Power:**	
Operator:	George Wilson	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Dusk
Observation Facility, Elevation:		**Distance from Accident Site:**	
Observation Time:		**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:		**Visibility**	10 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	Overcast / 1200 ft agl	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	10 knots / 20 knots	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	45°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:		**Temperature/Dew Point:**	24°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Key Largo, FL (NONE)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:		**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	EST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:		**Runway Surface Type:**	
Airport Elevation:		**Runway Surface Condition:**	
Runway Used:		**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:		**VFR Approach/Landing:**	

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	3 None	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	
Total Injuries:	4 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	25.041667, -80.488333

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Paul R Cox	**Report Date:**	02/28/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Don Behrle; FAA/FSDO; Miami, FL		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), established in 1967, is an independent federal agency mandated by Congress through the Independent Safety Board Act of 1974 to investigate transportation accidents, determine the probable causes of the accidents, issue safety recommendations, study transportation safety issues, and evaluate the safety effectiveness of government agencies involved in transportation. The NTSB makes public its actions and decisions through accident reports, safety studies, special investigation reports, safety recommendations, and statistical reviews.

The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.